ITG

INTERNAL IT · ERP · CUSTOMER · SUPPLIER SUPPORT

Support Desk Handbook

How to raise a ticket, how to work one, and how to run the desk.

For everyone who uses the support desk — requesters, staff, team leads, managers and administrators.

Describes the system as built, including the parts that are not finished yet.

Revision of 25 August 2026

Contents

Part 1 **Everyone**

EVERYONE

Getting in

Sign in with your work email address and the password your administrator issued. If you are asked to change it on first sign-in, that is deliberate — the account was created with a temporary password.

Your **My profile** page shows your organisation, department and email address. Those are set by your administrator, not by you. What you can change there is your password and whether the interface uses light or dark colours — that preference is stored in your browser alone, so it does not follow you to another machine.

Active sessions lists everywhere you are currently signed in, and lets you sign out of every device at once. Worth using if you have signed in on a shared machine on the factory floor.

> NOT AVAILABLE YET
>
> Two-factor authentication is described on the profile page but cannot be switched on. The sign-in code that would check it exists; the screen to enrol your authenticator app has not been built. Treat the desk as password-protected only.

EVERYONE

Finding your way

The sidebar shows only what your role permits, so two people can see quite different menus. Nothing is hidden to be tidy — if an item is missing, the permission behind it is missing too, and the server would refuse the action anyway.

GROUP	WHAT IS IN IT
Overview	Dashboard, My profile
Tickets	All tickets, Raise a ticket, My assigned, Unassigned queue, Escalations
Insight	Reports, Knowledge base, Audit log
Administration	Users, Staff workload, Roles & permissions, Teams, Categories, SLA policies, AI assistance, System settings

Every ticket carries a number in the form `TKT-2026-000001`. The prefix is configurable per organisation and the sequence restarts each January. Quote that number in any conversation about the ticket — it is the one identifier everybody shares.

EVERYONE

How you get told things

There are two channels, and the difference is deliberate. A **popup** interrupts you, and is used only when you personally can act right now. A **list entry** in the bell menu waits until you look, and is used for everything you need to know but need not drop what you are doing for.

Email follows a third rule again: it goes out when the thing matters and you might not be at the screen. The full table is in Who is told what.

> WORTH KNOWING
>
> If you raised a ticket yourself, you are not emailed about your own action. The system does not repeat back to you what you just typed.

Part 2 Raising and tracking a ticket

REQUESTER STAFF

Raising one well

Only four things are required: a **subject**, a **description**, an **impact** and an **urgency**. Everything else — category, subcategory, affected application and module, contact phone, tags — is optional and exists to get the ticket to the right team faster.

The description is the part that decides how quickly this gets fixed. Say what you were doing, what happened, and what you expected instead. Include any error message exactly as it appeared. A subject of "printer broken" costs somebody a phone call before work can start.

Where it goes

Choosing a category matters more than it looks. The ticket is routed to a team by walking three fallbacks in order: the **subcategory's** default team, then the **category's**, then the **owning team of the affected application**. If none of those is set, the ticket lands in the unassigned queue where any staff member can see it — which is slower, but never invisible.

FIELD	LIMIT	NOTES
Subject	300 characters	Required
Description	20,000 characters	Required
Tags	20 per ticket	Each 1–60 characters, de-duplicated
Contact phone	—	Defaults to the one on your user record
Contact email	—	Defaults to your account address

You cannot set the priority. It is calculated — see below.

REQUESTER STAFF LEAD

Impact, urgency and how priority is decided

Impact is how many people are affected. **Urgency** is how soon it must be dealt with. Both run Low, Medium, High, Critical. Priority is worked out from the pair using your organisation's matrix — a grid of sixteen cells your administrator can edit.

Where no cell has been customised, the default rule averages the two and rounds *up*. So High impact with Low urgency gives Medium, and rounding up means an urgent problem is never quietly demoted. It also means one Critical axis alone does not reach Critical — both have to be serious.

The cap on what a requester may claim

Everybody marks their own request urgent. Left unchecked that inflates every ticket to Critical, at which point the field carries no information at all and genuinely critical work is indistinguishable from the rest.

So a requester's claim is **capped, not rejected**. The default ceiling is **High** on both axes — high enough to say "this is serious and needs attention today". If you ask for Critical, the ticket is logged at High and *what you asked for is recorded alongside it*, so a team lead can see you pushed and raise it once they have looked.

The create form tells you the ceiling before you submit, and shows the priority the ticket will actually carry. Staff and above are taken at face value and see no warning at all.

> ADMINISTRATORS
>
> The ceiling is set by two settings keys, `tickets.requester_max_impact` and `tickets.requester_max_urgency`. Absent or unreadable values fall back to High rather than disabling the cap.

REQUESTER

Following your ticket

All tickets shows the ones you raised. Search accepts a ticket number, words from the subject, or words from the description, and you can filter by status and priority.

On the ticket itself you see the conversation, the current status, the calculated priority with the reason it was calculated that way, who it is assigned to, and the SLA clock — how long support has to reply and to resolve, and how much of that budget has been used.

> WHAT YOU WILL NOT SEE
>
> Internal notes between staff, and the hours logged against your ticket. Both are filtered out at the database, not hidden by the page, so they cannot leak through a bug in the interface.

REQUESTER

Confirming or rejecting a resolution

When support marks your ticket Resolved that is a *proposal*, not a conclusion. You get an email with the resolution summary and two options.

If it is fixed, **close** the ticket. You will be asked two quick questions — did it fix the problem, and how was the staff member. Ratings cannot be changed once submitted, and your comment is visible to the support team.

If it is not fixed, **reopen** it and say why. That reason is required: it is what tells the staff member what to revisit. Reopening keeps the whole history on one ticket rather than starting a new one, and the reopen count is reported on — a resolution that gets rejected is a signal the desk needs.

GAP

Nothing chases a resolved ticket you never respond to. The system can close such tickets automatically and even has a closure reason for it, but no job exists to do so. They stay open indefinitely.

Part 3 Working tickets

STAFF SPECIALIST LEAD

The three queues

- **My assigned** — yours. Worst first.
- **Unassigned queue** — tickets nobody has taken. Visible to every staff member regardless of team, deliberately: a ticket that matched no routing rule would otherwise be visible only to the person who raised it and to management, so nobody who could triage it would ever know it existed.
- **All tickets** — everything within your scope. What that includes depends on your role; see Roles and what they see.

Accepting a ticket does two things at once. If nobody owns it, you claim it — and if you belong to a team, the ticket picks up that team too. It then moves to In progress. If it is already assigned to somebody else, you cannot accept it without the reassign permission; ask, or take it over properly.

STAFF SPECIALIST LEAD

The lifecycle

The ordinary path through a ticket is short:

New → Assigned → In progress → Resolved → Closed

Around it sit the states that describe real interruptions: Waiting for requester, Waiting for third party, Escalated, Reopened and Cancelled.

The two waiting states matter beyond bookkeeping: they are what **pause the SLA clock**. Use them honestly. Internal delay — you are busy, the part is on order — does not pause anything, and should not.

Three rules are worth committing to memory. A new ticket cannot jump straight to resolved. A ticket cannot be closed until it has been resolved. Cancelled is the one state nothing comes back from — everything else, including closed, can be reopened.

The full matrix is in Status transitions.

STAFF SPECIALIST LEAD

Replies and internal notes

A **public reply** is seen by the requester and emailed to them. An **internal note** is staff-only and is filtered out of every requester-facing surface in the database query itself.

The distinction has a second effect people forget: only a public reply from somebody who is *not* the requester stops the first-response clock. An internal note does not, however thorough it is. Neither does the requester adding more detail to their own ticket.

When you reply publicly to a ticket that was waiting on the requester, and they reply back, the ticket returns to `In progress` on its own.

> ON A CLOSED TICKET
>
> Only holders of the internal-note permission may comment. Everybody else is told to reopen it first — a conversation continuing on a closed ticket is a conversation nobody is watching.

> GAP
>
> You can @-mention a colleague in a comment and the mention is stored, but **nobody is ever notified**. Not by email, not in the bell menu. Until that is wired up, tell people directly.

STAFF SPECIALIST LEAD

Logging work

The **Work logged** panel records who spent how long, on which day, and whether it is billable to the requesting department. It is separate from the closing “work performed” summary: that is one narrative written at the end, this is the running account an invoice or a capacity argument is built from.

- Time is always recorded against **you**. There is no way to log hours in somebody else’s name.
- Only the person who recorded an entry can withdraw it. A timesheet somebody else can quietly edit is not a record of anything.
- Entries are capped at 24 hours each — split a longer stretch across the days it happened.
- You may log work on a **closed** ticket. Timesheets get filled in on Friday for Tuesday’s work, and refusing the entry does not undo the hours.
- The work date may not be in the future, nor before the ticket existed.

Requesters never see this panel.

REQUESTER STAFF

Attachments

Images, video, PDFs, Zip archives and plain files are accepted, up to **100 MB** each. The type is determined by reading the file's actual content, not by trusting its extension, so renaming something to `.pdf` achieves nothing.

An attachment on an internal note inherits that note's visibility. Uploads are refused on a closed or cancelled ticket — reopen it first.

> **FOR YOUR IT TEAM**
>
> No malware scanner is connected. Every file is stored with the scan state *Skipped* and the note "No malware scanner is configured for this deployment." The hooks for one exist and nothing is wired to them. Worth deciding on before staff start opening attachments from outside the company.

STAFF LEAD

Resolving, closing, reopening, cancelling

Resolving requires a resolution summary. It is not paperwork: it is posted to the ticket as a public reply and it is what the requester reads to decide whether to accept the fix. Root cause and work performed are optional alongside it.

Closing needs the ticket to be resolved first (or waiting on the requester). A requester closing their own resolved ticket is confirming it; anybody else needs the close permission.

Reopening requires a reason, keeps the resolution summary on record as the thing that was rejected, and restarts the clock against the original targets.

Cancelling also requires a reason, and it is the only irreversible move. Use it when work is not happening — duplicate, no longer required, raised by mistake — never as a way of tidying the queue.

> **TWO DEFECTS TO KNOW ABOUT**
>
> A close where no closure reason is supplied is recorded as *"requester confirmed the resolution"* even when support closed it as a duplicate or out of scope. And every cancellation is recorded as *"cancelled by requester"* even when a manager cancelled it. Both corrupt the closure-reason figures; treat that column with suspicion until they are fixed.

Running the desk

MANAGER ADMIN

Roles, and what each one can see

Roles are rows in a database, not names in the code. Nothing anywhere branches on a role being called “Team Lead” — every check asks whether the person holds a particular permission. So you can rename, re-scope and re-permission these freely, and the seven below are simply the bundles the system ships with.

ROLE	SEES	CAN DO, IN PRACTICE
Requester	Own tickets	Raise, reply, attach, confirm or reject a resolution, reopen, cancel, read the knowledge base
Staff	Team + unassigned	Accept, edit, change status, resolve, write internal notes, log work, link ERP records, record root cause, use the AI assistant, draft knowledge articles
Technical Specialist	Team + unassigned	As Staff, plus transfer a ticket to another team and edit knowledge articles
Team Lead	Team + unassigned	Assign and reassign, change priority, close, own and acknowledge escalations, publish articles, delete attachments, read team reports
Manager	Whole organisation	As Team Lead across the organisation, plus export reports, edit SLA policies and priority matrices, archive articles
Administrator	Own tickets only	Configures the system: users, roles, teams, catalogue, calendars, notifications, settings, AI, audit log. Deliberately *not* a queue-working role
Super Admin	Everything	Every permission, including the Customer behaviour report, which no other role holds

> THE ADMINISTRATOR SURPRISE
>
> An Administrator can create users and rewrite permissions but can only see tickets they raised themselves. That is deliberate — configuring the desk and working it are different jobs — but it catches people out. If your administrator also needs to work tickets, give them a second role.

Scopes

A person’s scope is the widest one any of their roles grants. It decides which tickets they can see at all:

SCOPE	SEES
Own	Only tickets they raised. The safe default for anything unrecognised
Assigned	Raised by them or assigned to them
Team	Theirs, their teams’, and the unassigned pool
Department	Theirs, their department’s, and the unassigned pool
Organization	Everything in the organisation
All	Everything, still inside the organisation boundary

Asking for a ticket outside your scope returns *not found* rather than *forbidden*. A refusal would confirm the ticket exists, which is itself information.

> **PERMISSION CHANGES ARE NOT INSTANT**
> Permissions travel inside the access token and only refresh when it does — within about fifteen minutes. Removing a permission is not a way to contain somebody immediately. To cut off access now, deactivate the account and end their sessions.

MANAGER ADMIN

SLA policies

A policy sets, for each priority, how many **business minutes** support has to reply and to resolve, and at what percentage of the resolution budget a warning is raised. The shipped defaults:

PRIORITY	FIRST RESPONSE	RESOLUTION	WARNING AT
Critical	15 min	2 hours	70%
High	30 min	4 hours	70%
Medium	2 hours	8 hours	70%
Low	4 hours	24 hours	70%

A policy can be scoped to a category, a department, a ticket type, or any combination. When several match, the most specific wins — category counts for more than type, which counts for more than department — and the default policy breaks a tie.

Two properties worth understanding

Targets are copied onto the ticket when the clock starts. Editing a policy changes what future tickets promise, never what past tickets already promised. The policy list shows how many live clocks each policy owns for exactly this reason.

No policy means no promise. If nothing matches a ticket, it gets no SLA at all and the panel shows nothing rather than inventing a deadline. Make sure one policy is marked default.

Pausing

The clock pauses while a ticket is waiting on the requester or a third party, and only then. On resume, both deadlines are pushed out by exactly the time spent waiting. A breached clock keeps running — a breached ticket is not finished, it is actively failing, and it stays in the sweep so the escalation ladder keeps chasing it.

Changing priority

Raising a ticket's priority recalculates its deadlines against the new targets but *does not* restart the clock from now. Otherwise a well-timed priority bump could hide a breach. Any priority you set that differs from the calculated one needs a written reason, which is recorded.

UNUSED PERMISSION

`sla.override` is granted to Manager and Super Admin and is checked nowhere. Every SLA screen gates on `sla.manage` instead. Granting or withholding it changes nothing today.

ADMIN

Business hours and holidays

SLA minutes are *business* minutes, counted against a calendar. A calendar has a time zone, a set of working windows, and a list of holidays.

A window is one stretch on one weekday. **A split shift is two rows for the same day** — 09:00 to 13:00 and 14:00 to 18:00, not one row with a gap. Holidays can be fixed dates or recurring, where only the month and day matter.

The worked example that makes this concrete:

> WHY THE DEADLINE IS MONDAY
>
> A four-hour resolution target on a ticket raised at **16:00 on Friday**, under Monday–Friday 09:00–17:00, is due at **12:00 on Monday**. One hour is consumed on Friday afternoon; the remaining three are counted from Monday morning. Not 20:00 Friday.

Saving working hours **replaces** the whole set rather than merging, so send the complete week each time. Only one calendar may be the default, and it is used wherever an office or policy names none. If no windows are configured at all, the calendar is treated as round-the-clock cover — treating it as "no working time" would make every deadline unreachable.

For a Pakistan deployment, set the time zone to `Asia/Karachi` and add the local weekend and public holidays. Daylight-saving edge cases are handled conservatively: an ambiguous local time takes the earlier deadline, which is the safer reading of a commitment.

LEAD MANAGER ADMIN

The escalation ladder

Escalation rungs are defined as a **percentage of the resolution budget**, not a fixed time. That way one ladder works for a fifteen-minute critical target and a twenty-four-hour low one alike. Percentages above 100 are meaningful and expected: a rung at 120 chases a ticket that has already breached.

LEVEL	FIRES AT	GOES TO	CHANGES THE TICKET STATUS
1	70%	The assigned staff member	No
2	90%	The team lead	No
3	100%	The team lead	**Yes** — moves to Escalated
4	120%	The department manager	No

Recipients are resolved *at the moment of escalation*, not stored on the policy, so changing a team lead takes effect immediately. A rung that resolves nobody — a ticket with no team, so no lead — is still recorded, with the reason saying so. An escalation that reached no one is a fact worth keeping, not a silent no-op.

A paused clock escalates nothing. If nobody is consuming budget, nobody is late.

The escalation screen

Anyone with escalation view sees the queue. A summary strip across the top gives the numbers that actually matter to somebody supervising rather than working: how many are waiting for someone, how many are owned but still open, how many have gone past the first rung, the age of the oldest unacknowledged one, and how many were settled this week.

Acknowledging says "I have seen this and I own it". It deliberately does not resolve the escalation — the ticket being fixed does that. Acknowledging one somebody else already took changes nothing rather than overwriting their name. Resolving or cancelling the ticket settles its escalations automatically.

> NO SCREEN FOR THIS YET
>
> The escalation ladder itself has no administration page. The default four rungs are created once per organisation at first startup and can only be changed in the database.

ADMIN

The catalogue and teams

Two parallel two-level trees, which together decide where a ticket goes:

- **Category** → **Subcategory** — what kind of problem it is. Each level can carry a default team, an SLA policy override, and a required skill. A category can be marked internal-only, which hides it from requesters while leaving it available to staff.
- **Application** → **Module** — which system is affected. Each carries an owning team. An application can be flagged business-critical.

A **team** has a lead, who receives level-one escalations, and a fallback team for work it cannot take. Members carry a capacity weight — 0.5 gives someone half the share of automatic assignments, and 0 keeps them on the team but out of the rotation entirely.

Removing somebody from a team deactivates the membership rather than deleting it, and is blocked while they still hold open tickets for that team.

> ROUTING IS SIMPLER THAN IT LOOKS
>
> There are no configurable routing rules, despite a permission and an assignment method suggesting otherwise. Routing is the three-step fallback described under Raising one well. Round-robin, least-active, weighted and skill-based assignment are named in the code but not implemented — assignment is manual or self-service today.

STAFF LEAD MANAGER

The knowledge base

An article moves through four states, and each hop needs a different permission:

Draft → In review → Published → Archived

ACTION	WHO
Read published articles	Everyone
Create a draft	Staff and above
Edit	Technical Specialist and above
Publish	Team Lead and above
Archive	Manager and above

A new article always starts as a draft whatever you asked for — publishing is a separate, separately permitted act, so nothing reaches readers just because somebody hit save. Unpublished articles are visible only to their author and to people who can edit.

Visibility is set per article: **internal** for staff only, **organisation** for everyone in your company including requesters, or **public**. Archiving never deletes — an article that turned out to be wrong is still evidence of what was advised. Every edit writes a version, not just every publish.

> **AN AWKWARD GAP IN THE MIDDLE**
>
> Staff can *create* an article but cannot *edit* one — editing is a separate permission they do not hold. So a staff member can write a draft and then not touch it again, not even to fix a typo, and cannot move it to review. Either grant Staff the edit permission or expect drafts to stall.

LEAD MANAGER ADMIN

Reports and the audit log

REPORT	ANSWERS
SLA compliance	Are we meeting what we promised, by team, category and priority
Volume and backlog	Are we keeping up — raised against resolved, day by day
Staff performance	Throughput beside reopens, breaches and satisfaction, because volume alone rewards the wrong thing
Satisfaction	What requesters said after the fix
Customer behaviour	Who over-claims severity, reopens most, sits on confirmations. **Super Admin only**

All five export to CSV for anyone with the export permission — except Customer behaviour, which needs its own permission on top, because it names individuals and says unflattering things about them. Every export is audited: it is the moment data leaves the system's access controls and becomes a spreadsheet on somebody's laptop.

Staff workload is a separate screen and answers a different question: not how last month went, but who can take the next ticket right now. It lists everybody who can hold work, including people holding none — an empty queue is the most useful row on the screen when you are looking for somewhere to put something.

The audit log

Twenty-one kinds of action are recorded permanently, including the ones that were refused. Logins and failed logins, token reuse detection, permission and role changes, status and priority changes, assignments, escalations, SLA overrides, attachment uploads *and downloads*, exports, and whether an AI recommendation was accepted or rejected.

Each entry keeps the actor's name and email as they were at the time, so deleting a user later does not erase who did what. Comment bodies are never recorded — the log captures that a comment was made, by whom and of what kind, not its contents.

ADMIN

Email setup

The desk sends over standard SMTP. There is no third-party email service, no account to sign up for, and no per-message cost — point it at your mail server and it sends. Delivery is queued and retried in the background, so nothing waits on the mail server, and every attempt is recorded with its outcome.

SETTING	WHAT IT IS	DEFAULT
`Email:Enabled`	Master switch	off
`Email:Host`	SMTP server	—
`Email:Port`	Port	587
`Email:UseStartTls`	Upgrade to TLS — for port 587	true
`Email:UseSsl`	TLS from the first byte — for port 465	false
`Email:UserName`	Account to log in as	falls back to the from-address
`Email:Password`	Mailbox or app password	—
`Email:FromAddress`	Who it appears to come from	—
`Email:FromName`	Display name	Support Desk
`Email:RedirectAllTo`	Send *everything* to one address	unset

In production these are environment variables, with a double underscore in place of the colon — `Email__Host`. The password never belongs in `appsettings.json`, which is committed to source control.

On startup the log states exactly what it picked up, including whether a password is present, and names the problem if the settings are obviously wrong. If mail is not arriving, that line is the first place to look.

TWO RULES FOR GOING LIVE

Never set `Email:RedirectAllTo` in production — it silently swallows every message into one inbox. Do set it on any staging copy loaded with real data, which is exactly what it exists for. And send from a shared mailbox such as `support@itgroup.com`, never a person's account, so the desk keeps working when that person leaves.

Part 5 Reference

STAFF LEAD ADMIN

Status transitions

Every legal move. Anything not listed is refused by the server.

FROM	MAY BECOME
New	Assigned, In progress, Escalated, Cancelled
Assigned	Assigned (reassignment), In progress, Waiting ×2, Escalated, Resolved, Cancelled
In progress	Assigned, Waiting ×2, Escalated, Resolved, Cancelled
Waiting for requester	In progress, Waiting for third party, Escalated, Resolved, **Closed**, Cancelled
Waiting for third party	In progress, Waiting for requester, Escalated, Resolved, Cancelled
Escalated	In progress, Assigned, Waiting ×2, Resolved, Cancelled
Resolved	Closed, Reopened, In progress
Closed	Reopened only
Reopened	Assigned, In progress, Waiting ×2, Escalated, Resolved, Cancelled
Cancelled	Nothing — terminal

Entry requirements

- **Resolved** needs a resolution summary.
- **Assigned** needs a person or a team.
- **Closed** requires the ticket to be resolved, or waiting on the requester.
- **Cancelled** needs a written reason.

EVERYONE

Who is told what

The requester

EVENT	EMAILED
Ticket raised on their behalf by staff	Yes — not if they raised it themselves
Public reply from support	Yes — internal notes never
Resolved	Yes, with the summary
Closed	Yes
Assignment, SLA, escalation	**No** — the desk's business, not theirs

Staff and supervision

EVENT	THE ASSIGNEE	SUPERVISION
New ticket arrives	Popup + email	—
Assigned to you	Popup + email	—
SLA warning	Popup, no email	List entry, no email
SLA breach	Popup + email	List entry + email
Escalation, any rung	Popup + email	List entry + email

"Supervision" means anyone whose role carries SLA management, escalation management or user management — today Super Admin, Administrator, Manager and Team Lead — plus the lead of the assigned team. Somebody who is both assignee and supervisor gets one notification, not two.

A ticket with no assignee goes to the whole team it landed in. A ticket with neither assignee nor team notifies nobody at all — it sits in the unassigned queue until the SLA sweep starts chasing it.

Nothing is emailed for status changes, priority changes, reopening, internal notes, work logged, or an escalation being acknowledged.

MANAGER ADMIN

Not built yet

Everything below is a real limitation of the system as it stands. None of it is speculation, and it is better read here than discovered in month two.

AREA	WHAT IS MISSING	WHAT IT MEANS DAY TO DAY
Two-factor sign-in	No enrolment screen	Accounts are password-only
@-mentions	Nothing raises a notification	Mentioning a colleague tells them nothing
Reopening	The assignee is not notified	They find out by looking — arguably the most important thing to hear about
Auto-close	No background job	Tickets waiting on a silent requester stay open forever
Attachments	No malware scanner connected	Every file is stored unscanned
Escalation ladders	No admin screen	Changing the rungs means changing the database
Routing	No rules engine; automatic assignment not implemented	Assignment is manual or self-service
Knowledge base	Staff can create but not edit	Drafts stall unless Staff are given the edit permission
Closure reasons	Two defects mis-record why work stopped	Treat closure-reason figures as unreliable for now
`sla.override`	Granted but never checked	Has no effect either way